



Douglas DC-2

The ancestor of the famed DC-3 “Dakota,” the DC-2 first flew in 1933 in response to an order by TWA. The 14-seat passenger airplane would become the first airliner to offer passengers comfortable, safe, and reliable air travel. Some 192 were built before the ubiquitous DC-3 took precedence. Today the Douglas DC-2 is a rare survivor of the golden age of flying and represents one of the turning points in commercial aviation.

IN 1933 Transcontinental and Western Air (TWA) issued a specification for an all-metal trimotor airliner to rival the Boeing 247s in service with United Airlines. Donald Douglas realized he could meet the performance on two engines alone and the first Douglas Commercial (DC) airliner flew on July 1 that year. The aircraft achieved many speed records but Douglas doubted the sales potential for the type. TWA ordered 20 DC-2 versions (with two extra seats and 730 hp engines) and the type entered service with the airline on May 18, 1934.

In 1934 KLM Royal Dutch Airlines entered its first DC-2 into the MacRobertson Trophy Air Race from England to Australia. Astonishingly, the passenger- and mail-carrying airliner came second ahead of airplanes specially built for racing.

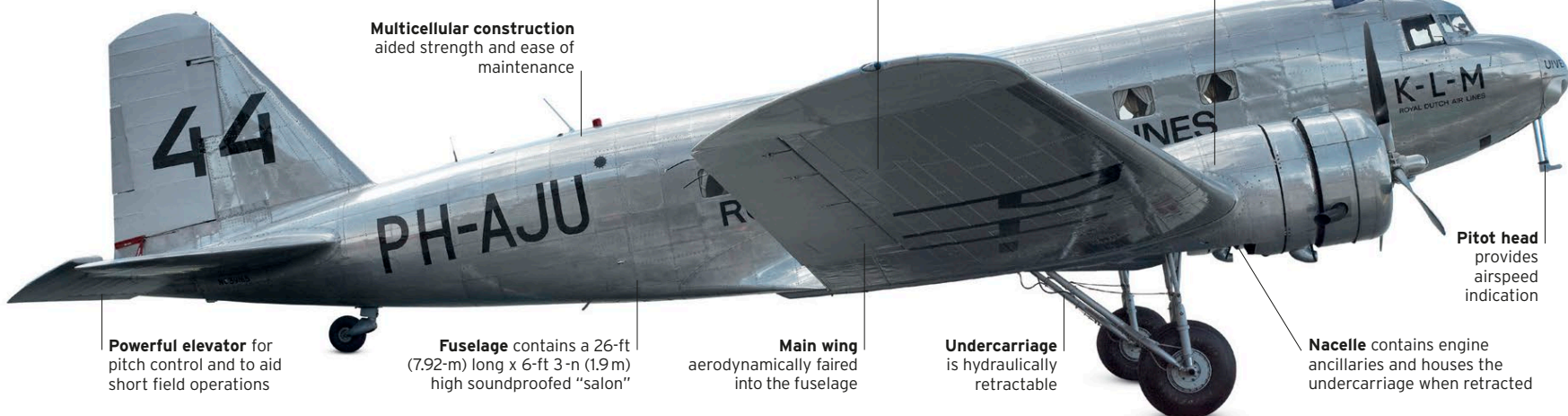
The high-speed, high-capacity airliner proved to be such a success that it would go on to serve with military and civilian owners, and even formed the basis for the B-18 Bolo bomber that served the United States Army Air Force during the late 1930s.



FRONT VIEW



REAR VIEW



Multicellular construction
aided strength and ease of
maintenance

Efficient wing section
boasts powerful flaps
to allow operation from
short runways

Wright R-1820
Cyclone 9-cylinder
radial engine (730 hp)

Pitot head
provides
airspeed
indication

Nacelle contains engine
ancillaries and houses the
undercarriage when retracted

Undercarriage
is hydraulically
retractable

Main wing
aerodynamically faired
into the fuselage

Fuselage contains a 26-ft
(7.92-m) long x 6-ft 3-in (1.9 m)
high soundproofed “salon”

Powerful elevator for
pitch control and to aid
short field operations